AI makes public data easy to read and private data more valuable, so demand for private computation rises

Exposure gets cheaper

AI can analyse large volumes of public data. Transaction histories that once took real effort to interpret become easy to examine at scale.

Private data gets more valuable

Useful assistants need access to private communications, preferences and business records, so people and companies disclose more to them.

Demand for computation that uses data without exposing it

Nillion (Hack VC) builds private computation for AI and data. Seismic (a16z) computes over shared private data with secure hardware.

Sources: Vitalik Buterin, Why I support privacy (Apr 2025); Hack VC, Nillion investment thesis; a16z, Investing in Seismic.